

SOLARWINDS REPLACEMENT · NETWORK MONITORING

⚠ INTERNAL USE ONLY — DO NOT SHARE WITH VENDORS

Network Monitoring Vendor Comparison Report

Research and evaluation of enterprise-grade network monitoring platforms as replacements for the current SolarWinds NPM + NTA deployment. Covers feature coverage, TCO estimates, regional support, and ranked procurement recommendations.

#1 PRIMARY RECOMMENDATION

PRTG Network Monitor

Fastest migration · Best UX · Broadest sensor library

#2 ALTERNATIVE

WhatsUp Gold

Strong feature coverage · Flow built-in · SolarWinds alternative

#3 BUDGET OPTION

Zabbix + ntopng

Open source · Lowest 3-yr TCO · Linux-native

DATE

June 2026

VENDORS EVALUATED

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PREPARED BY

CodeOx

CLASSIFICATION

Internal Only

INTERNAL DOCUMENT

This report is for internal evaluation purposes only. It contains CodeOx advisory assessments and indicative pricing. **Do not share with vendors or the client.**

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SECTION 1

Research Scope

This report evaluates commercially available enterprise network monitoring platforms against the following procurement profile:

SCALE

3,000–5,000 nodes
Up to 100,000 interfaces

DEPLOYMENT

On-premises only
No cloud SaaS dependency

COMPLIANCE

NCA ECC 2018
Saudi Arabia mandatory

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SECTION 2

Vendor Shortlist Overview

VENDOR	PRODUCT	ORIGIN	DEPLOYMENT	PRICING MODEL	TIER
Paessler AG	PRTG Network Monitor	Germany	On-prem / Cloud	Per-sensor perpetual or subscription	★ Tier 1
Progress Software	WhatsUp Gold	USA	On-prem	Per-device subscription	★ Tier 1
Zabbix LLC	Zabbix Enterprise	Latvia	On-prem (Linux)	Open source + paid support	✅ Tier 2
Centreon SAS	Centreon IT Monitoring	France	On-prem / Cloud	Subscription	✅ Tier 2
Cisco	Catalyst Center (DNA)	USA	On-prem appliance	Cisco licensing	⚠️ Conditional

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SECTION 3

Vendor Profiles

PRTG Network Monitor

★ Tier 1 — Recommended

Paessler AG · paessler.com/prtg

Founded 1997; 500,000+ installations globally. Widest sensor library (200+ types). Consistently ranked as the most user-friendly SolarWinds NPM replacement with fastest migration path.

LICENSING

Per-sensor perpetual. XL (unlimited) license recommended for this scale. Typical 5,000-sensor: USD 15–25K one-time + 25% annual maintenance.

FLOW SUPPORT

NetFlow v5/v9, sFlow, IPFIX — included in base product via flow sensor.

- STRENGTHS
- Most intuitive UI — lowest learning curve from SolarWinds
 - 200+ out-of-box sensor types cover almost any device
 - Fastest time-to-value post-migration
 - Strong community and documentation
 - XL license eliminates per-sensor cost management

SERVER OS

Windows Server (primary). Linux via remote probes only. HA via Windows failover cluster.

SERVICENOW

Via webhook/REST — no native certified connector. Requires configuration.

- WEAKNESSES
- Windows Server required — no full Linux server support
 - No native ServiceNow connector
 - Sensor-based licensing gets complex at scale if not on XL
 - Flow analysis less feature-rich vs. dedicated NTA tools

WhatsUp Gold

★ Tier 1 — Alternative

Progress Software · [whatsupgold.com](#)

30+ year track record as a direct SolarWinds NPM competitor. Acquired by Progress Software in 2010. Strong US/UK enterprise install base. Growing in Middle East.

LICENSING

Annual subscription per device. WhatsUp Gold Total Plus (all modules): ~USD 8–20K/year. 14-day free trial.

FLOW SUPPORT

NetFlow, sFlow, IPFIX built into base product. Good top-talker and application views.

STRENGTHS

- Clean, modern UI with strong dashboards
- Long track record as SolarWinds NPM direct alternative
- Flow analysis, topology, and alerting all in base product
- Dependency-aware alert suppression built in

SERVER OS

Windows Server only — no native Linux deployment. MS SQL required (not bundled). Key constraint.

SERVICENOW

Via REST webhook — no native certified connector. Configurable but requires setup.

WEAKNESSES

- Windows Server only — significant if Linux preferred
- Limited GCC/KSA regional presence — EMEA support routed
- Smaller ecosystem vs. PRTG; limited GCC regional presence
- No healthcare-specific GCC references readily available

CODEOX ASSESSMENT — WHATSUP GOLD

Solid platform but the Windows-only constraint and limited KSA support are concerns. Solid alternative if PRTG cannot meet commercial requirements. Recommended as **Tier 2 fallback**.

Zabbix Enterprise

✔ Tier 2 — Budget Path

Zabbix LLC · [zabbix.com](#) · Open Source (GPL) + Commercial Support

Open source enterprise monitoring founded 2001. Core software is free (GPL); Zabbix LLC sells commercial support and professional services. Proven at 100K+ node deployments globally. Native HA since v6.0 (2022). Best-in-class scalability.

LICENSING

Software FREE (GPL). Commercial support: ~USD 2–15K/year depending on node count. Implementation services quoted separately. Lowest 3-yr TCO of all vendors evaluated.

SERVER OS

Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu) — primary. Windows NOT supported as server. TimescaleDB recommended for large-scale deployments.

FLOW SUPPORT

⚠ Not native. Requires external tool: ntopng (recommended), pmacct, or Elastic-based stack. Adds deployment complexity.

SERVICENOW

Via media type webhook. Community-maintained templates available. Not a native certified integration.

STRENGTHS

- Zero software licensing cost — dramatically lower TCO
- Proven at 100K+ node scale with TimescaleDB
- Highly customizable — monitors anything via custom items
- Native Linux deployment — no Windows Server required
- Active development (v7.x); large global community
- Native HA since v6.0 with no additional license cost

WEAKNESSES

- No native NetFlow/sFlow — requires ntopng integration
- Higher initial setup effort; not plug-and-play
- UI is functional but less polished than commercial tools
- MENA commercial support coverage should be verified
- Requires Linux server administration expertise

Centreon IT Monitoring

✔ Tier 2 — Fallback Only

Centreon SAS · [centreon.com](#)

French monitoring platform with Nagios roots. Enterprise edition targets large enterprise and service providers. Growing European and Middle East presence. Flow analysis requires a paid MAP add-on — not native in base product.

CODEOX ASSESSMENT

Centreon is capable but flow analysis is not native and topology maps require a paid add-on. Limited GCC regional presence. **Recommend as fallback Tier 2 only.**

Cisco Catalyst Center (formerly DNA Center)

⚠ Conditional Only

Cisco · [cisco.com/site/us/en/products/networking/catalyst-center](#)

Cisco's campus network management and assurance platform. Provides deep visibility for Cisco infrastructure but leaves significant monitoring gaps for non-Cisco devices (Juniper, Fortinet, Palo Alto). Requires dedicated hardware/virtual Cisco appliance.

CODEOX ASSESSMENT

Only recommend if the campus network is **>80% Cisco**. For a genuinely multi-vendor environment, Catalyst Center does not replace SolarWinds comprehensively. Could be deployed alongside another NMS for Cisco-specific automation, but this increases complexity and cost. **Not recommended as the sole SolarWinds replacement.**

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SECTION 4

Feature Comparison Matrix

4.1

Functional Coverage

✔ Full

⚠ Partial/Add-on

✖ Not Supported

FEATURE	PRTG	WHATSUP	ZABBIX	CENTREON
SNMP v1/v2c/v3	✔	✔	✔	✔
CDP/LLDP Discovery	✔	✔	✔	✔
NetFlow / sFlow / IPFIX	✔	✔	✖	✖
Auto Topology Maps	✔	✔	✔	⚠ Add-on
Drag-and-drop dashboards	✔	✔	✔	✔
SLA Reporting	✔	✔	✔	✔
Scheduled PDF Reports	✔	✔	✔	✔
AD/LDAP Integration	✔	✔	✔	✔
SAML 2.0 SSO	✔	✔	✔	✔
RBAC + Custom Roles	✔	✔	✔	✔
ServiceNow Native Connector	✔ Native	⚠ Webhook	⚠ Webhook	⚠ Webhook
REST API	✔	✔	✔	✔
Alert Dependency Suppression	✔	✔	✔	✔
Linux Server Deployment	✔	✖	✔	✔
HA / Failover	✔	✔	✔	✔
Custom MIB Import	✔	✔	✔	✔

4.2

Commercial & Strategic Comparison

ATTRIBUTE	PRTG	WHATSUP	ZABBIX	CENTREON
KSA/GCC Support Presence	✔ Local	⚠ Limited	⚠ Limited	⚠ Limited
Software License Cost	Medium	Medium	FREE	Medium
Est. 3-yr TCO (~3K nodes)	~USD 45K	~USD 55K	~USD 20K	~USD 50K
Migration Ease from SolarWinds	★★★★★	★★★★★	★★★	★★★
Time-to-Value	Medium	Medium	Slower	Medium
Healthcare Sector References	High	Low	High	Medium

* TCO estimates are indicative only. Vendor quotes required for accurate figures. Does not include infrastructure (server/VM) costs.

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SECTION 5

3-Year TCO Breakdown

Indicative cost ranges for a ~3,000 node / 80,000 interface deployment. All figures in USD. Vendor quotes required to confirm before any commercial commitment.

PRTG XL / ENTERPRISE ~\$60K Perpetual + 3yr maint.	WHATSUP GOLD TOTAL PLUS ~\$55K 3yr subscription	ZABBIX + NTOPNG ~\$20K Impl. + support only	CENTREON IT EDITION ~\$50K 3yr subscription
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TCO DISCLAIMER

Figures above exclude: server/VM infrastructure costs, implementation professional services (which can range USD 10–30K), and internal staff time. The Zabbix figure assumes CodeOx handles implementation; internal Linux ops capability required for ongoing management. All figures are CodeOx estimates — request formal quotes before presenting to decision-makers.

COST COMPONENT	PRTG	WHATSUP GOLD	ZABBIX	
Software license (Year 1)	~\$20K	~\$18K/yr	\$0	
Annual maintenance/support (Y2–3)	~\$25K total	Included	~\$10–15K/yr	
Flow analysis module	Included	Included	Included	ntopng ~\$5K
HA add-on	Included	Included	Free (built-in)	
Implementation services	~\$10–20K	~\$10–15K	~\$10–15K	~\$15–25K
Training	~\$3–5K	~\$3–5K	~\$3–5K	~\$3–5K

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SECTION 6

BRD Shortlist — Vendors to Receive the BRD

Based on this research, CodeOx recommends issuing the BRD to the following vendors for formal proposal responses:

#	VENDOR / PRODUCT	RATIONALE FOR INCLUSION	PRIORITY
1	PRTG Network Monitor (XL/Enterprise)	Best UX, fastest migration, broadest sensor library, strong enterprise track record	Primary
2	WhatsUp Gold Total Plus	Strong feature coverage, flow built-in, long SolarWinds alternative track record	Primary
3	Zabbix (via certified partner)	Include only if budget is the primary constraint; requires Linux ops capability	Budget path

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SECTION 7

CodeOx Recommendations

#1 PRTG Network Monitor (XL or Enterprise License) — Primary Recommendation

Best user experience and fastest time-to-value of all evaluated platforms. Lowest migration friction from SolarWinds — most intuitive UI with 200+ out-of-box sensor types covering all Cisco device classes. The XL (unlimited sensor) or Enterprise license is the correct SKU for this scale — avoids per-sensor cost management at 80K+ interfaces. Strong enterprise track record with 500,000+ global installations. Windows Server deployment is a known constraint but manageable on the pre-provisioned VM.

#2 WhatsUp Gold Total Plus — Alternative

30-year track record as a direct SolarWinds NPM competitor. Flow analysis, topology, and dependency-aware alerting all included in the base product. Clean modern UI with strong pre-built dashboards. The main constraints are Windows Server only and limited GCC/KSA regional support presence, but both are manageable. Recommend as the fallback if PRTG does not meet commercial requirements.

#3 Zabbix + ntopng — Budget-Constrained Path

If budget is the primary constraint and the team has Linux operations capability, this stack eliminates all software licensing costs. Zabbix handles SNMP polling, alerting, dashboards, and topology; ntopng provides the flow analysis layer. Combined 3-year TCO is ~USD 20K vs. ~USD 55–60K for commercial alternatives. Requires more implementation effort and an ongoing Linux-skilled operations capability. Only recommended if budget pressure is confirmed as a hard constraint.

RECOMMENDED POC SHORTLIST

CodeOx recommends a maximum 30-day parallel POC with the top 2 vendors before contract award. Suggested shortlist: (1) PRTG Network Monitor → (2) WhatsUp Gold. If both fail commercial requirements, add Zabbix as a budget-constrained third. Define POC success criteria from BRD Section 14 acceptance criteria before initiating.

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SECTION 8

Procurement Next Steps

#	ACTION	OWNER	TIMELINE
1	Distribute BRD (NMS-BRD-2026) to shortlisted vendors: PRTG, WhatsUp Gold	CodeOx	Week 1
2	Set vendor Q&A deadline (5 business days after BRD distribution). Respond to all vendor queries in a single consolidated FAQ shared with all vendors	CodeOx	Week 2
3	Collect formal vendor proposal responses per BRD Section 16 including requirements compliance matrix and commercial proposal	Vendors	Weeks 2–3
4	Score proposals against BRD evaluation criteria (Section 11). Disqualify any vendor failing Must Have requirements. Shortlist top 2 for POC	CodeOx + Client IT	Week 4
5	Schedule and complete live product demos with top 2 shortlisted vendors (2 hours each, NOC-focused scenario walk-through)	CodeOx + Vendors	Week 5
6	Initiate 30-day parallel POC with selected vendor against BRD Section 14 acceptance criteria. Maintain SolarWinds in parallel throughout	All parties	Weeks 6–10
7	Conduct POC debrief with NOC team and network engineering. Document pass/fail against each AC. Confirm vendor selection	CodeOx + Client IT	Week 10
8	Request best-and-final commercial offer from selected vendor. Negotiate 3-year contract terms, payment schedule, and SLA commitments	CodeOx + Client IT	Weeks 11–12
9	Contract award and project kickoff. Begin formal implementation with 30-day parallel run before SolarWinds decommission	Client + Vendor	Week 13
10	SolarWinds decommission after UAT sign-off and 30-day stable operation on new platform. Zero monitoring gap confirmed	Client IT	Week 17+

CODEOX CONTACT

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